# EXEMPLIFYING RIVER RESTORATION

At the onset of India's 75th year of independence this year, the country is witnessing celebrations across the country under the Azadi Ka Amrit Mahotsav campaign. Launched by the Government of India, the campaign celebrates not just 75 years of India's independence, but also mobilizes citizens to work towards actualizing Hon'ble Prime Minster's vision of India 2.0 fueled with the spirit of Atmanirbhar Bharat.

In India's post independent journey, the water sector has seen a gradual but significant progress; which has picked up significant pace in the few years. The management of water resources has seen a paradigm shift in India since 2014. Water governance is placed at the forefront of the country's development agenda. In 2019, the Government of India established the Ministry of Jal Shakti, by bringing all aspects of water related governance under the aegis of a single Ministry. The positive results under Namami-Gange Programme, the expeditious completion of irrigation projects under Pradhan Mantri Krishi Sinchai Yojana, a renewed participatory approach towards groundwater management through Atal Bhujal Yojana, the improvement in availability of hydrological data through National Hydrology Project and National Project on Aquifer Management exemplify the holistic transformation India's water sector has undergone in the past few years. Jal Jeevan Mission and Jal Shakti Abhiyan (JSA) are two other time-bound campaigns being undertaken to ensure safe drinking water supply to every household through source sustainability. The phenomenal success of the "JSA:Catch the Rain" campaign, with the tagline Catch The rain: Where it Falls, When it Falls launched by Hon'ble Prime Minister on World Water day- 22 March 2021, which saw more than 47 lakh rainwater harvesting structures built, setup over 400 Jal Shakti Kendras, inventoried all the waterbodies in the country and prepared water conservation plans in over 2 lakh Gram Panchayats by synergizing the efforts of various government departments and converging schemes and funds for conservation of water, made Jal-Andolan a truly Jan-Andolan.

Namami Gange Programme is one of the flagship programmes of the government for the rejuvenation of the Ganga River Basin. Its success in a relatively short period of time has piqued the curiosity of people worldwide and is being considered as a model to be for all rivers of the country and in many parts of the world.

Ganga, the National River of India, is one of the most important symbols of not just Indian civilization but India's culture. The steps taken in the past few years under Namami-Gange Programme are in sync with the essence of the Azadi Ka Amrit Mahotsav that envisions building up a new Atmanirbhar Bharat.